Down on the Farm

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Teen And Up Audiences

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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Scorpia (She-Ra), Perfuma (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra)

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Down on the Farm

by TheSofterGentlerMe

Summary

Catra and Perfuma take a short trip to go and pick up some hay.

Notes

Shall we?

See the end of the work for more notes

Catra had her arm resting on the window of the old pickup that Camp Bright Moon used for running errands. She was pretty sure it was older than she was, and looked it, with no panel of the body of the vehicle the same color. When she'd first seen it, she'd thought it was intentional but then she'd noticed that the paint colors were all faded differently and the dents and scratches probably weren't supposed to be there. The engine still ran well though, even if the ride wasn't the smoothest which she was reminded of as they hit a bump in the road.

"Whoop! I'm so sorry," the woman driving said. Catra still had no idea why the arts and crafts counselor was going to the farm with her but considering Catra didn't have a driver's license yet, she couldn't really argue.

"Perfuma, it's fine," Catra said, using the woman's camp nickname. Catra had to admit it was proper. The woman made her own perfumes and other cosmetics, right down to growing an extensive garden at the camp and extracting her own oils. She always smelled like some concoction of various plants and dressed in flowing sundresses, scarves, and sandals. Catra found her a bit confusing sometimes though. She talked about all kinds of things like the magic of crystals, the power of self-actualization, various other mystical things that Catra had no idea about, and Tarot cards and horoscopes.

Catra had found out about the Tarot cards when Perfuma had pulled them out one rainy evening when some of the older counselors had been hanging out in the arts and crafts space. Even though Catra didn't believe much in Christianity, even before she'd left her former church camp, Catra's upbringing had been enough to make her feel weird about the whole thing. Poor Adora

had almost frozen stiff as she'd seen what she thought of as a tool of Satan get set on a table. Catra and Adora had excused themselves a few minutes after when Catra had figured out just how freaked out Adora had been. The next day, Adora had gone to Perfuma to apologize and ended up in a big discussion about religion. Catra hadn't bothered, figuring that Adora's conversation would cover it but she was beginning to think that Perfuma thought she'd offended her or something, especially since the woman seemed to apologize every other sentence.

"You know, you don't have to apologize to me constantly," Catra said as they hit another bump.

"It's alright," Perfuma said. "I just want to be polite."

The creaking of the truck was the only noise for a moment before Catra said, "Did I make you mad or something?"

Perfuma glanced at her as she said, "Why would you say that?"

"I don't know," Catra said. "I'm just used to passive-aggressive stuff and all the apologizing makes me think of that."

"No, you didn't anger me. I just worry that perhaps you hold me in a negative light," Perfuma said. "I understand you might not agree with my spiritual journey."

Catra snorted as Perfuma turned on to a bridge going over the river. Catra watched as the iron structure of the bridge flicked past as she said, "OK, this is about the Tarot thing the other night isn't it?"

Perfuma slowly nodded as she said, "I have spoken with Adora about her feelings on it and while I think she is not clearly seeing what it is about, she has been open with her feelings about it and we have reached an understanding."

"Where you and I haven't talked about it and you think I'm freaked out," Catra said. "Not to mention that you think that I think that you're some kind of evil person or something and I'm just being polite."

Perfuma nodded as she turned and started up a road. Catra felt herself get nervous. They were headed for a farm to pick up a few extra bales of hay they needed but the road itself went right past Camp Horde for the Lord, the camp Catra and Adora had left about a month before with quite a bit of drama, and she wasn't sure how she'd feel. She could still see it when she was at the docks at Camp Bright Moon but seeing it from across a river on top of a bluff and seeing it up close driving past were two different things.

"You're being honest so I shall share my truth as well," Perfuma said. "Even now as you say it, I can see you getting tense."

"I'm really not," Catra responded as she took a deep breath. The air was hot and the wind was blowing in from the river so the

smell of river, dust, and brush along the road mingled into what she thought of as the smell of summer. “I mean, yeah, it’s different to me, I’d even say weird, but I don’t think you’re a bad person or something.”

“Why are you nervous then?” Perfuma asked.

Catra was still watching the side of the road, waiting for the big cross and sign that indicated the camp entrance, when she said, “I’m really not, seriously.”

“Catra, I understand you may be used to not revealing your feelings but I want you to consider this a safe space for you,” Perfuma said gently.

Catra looked at her as she said, “Listen, I’m serious. I’m fine with your thing. I’m not going to come and have a huge conversation with you about it is all.”

Then Catra watched as they came up to the top of a hill and she saw the gravel parking lot of Camp Horde for the Lord. There was a big cross by the gate with the sign of the camp across the arms. A low white pipe fence ran along the road and on the other side of the parking lot stood more big crosses with numbers nailed to the middle of them. She remembered going to stand under one her first time to camp and being so nervous and scared because she didn’t know anyone and no one seemed interested in getting to know her. Then she realized Perfuma was looking at her out of the corner of her eye as she drove.

“Stop it,” Catra said.

“You weren’t nervous about me back there,” Perfuma said as the road turned a little and they lost sight of the parking lot.

“No, I wasn’t. Just like I said,” Catra said.

“I’m sorry. I should have taken you at your word,” Perfuma said.

“It’s alright,” Catra said.

“Why do Christians use such an awful symbol?” Perfuma said out of nowhere.

“What? You mean the cross?” Catra said and Perfuma nodded. “Because Jesus died on it to save the world.”

“Why not the fish symbol I see sometimes? That seems friendlier at least,” Perfuma said.

Catra snorted as she said, “I guess.”

“What does it mean?” Perfuma said.

“The fish? It’s a reference to being fishers of people, to try and convert them,” Catra said.

“See? That’s nicer than something you get killed on at least. Why not that?” Perfuma said.

Catra shrugged as she said, “You’re asking the wrong person. Ask Adora. She’s way more knowledgeable about it. Kind of surprised you don’t know the cross thing if I’m being honest by the way.”

Perfuma shrugged as she said, “I grew up on a commune and no one in my family is religious like that.”

“Sounds nice,” Catra said as she glanced in the rearview mirror before leaning back against the door.

“Do you miss all of that?” Perfuma said.

“I really don’t want to talk about all of that,” Catra said.

“I’m sorry,” Perfuma replied.

Catra shook her head as she said, “Again, don’t apologize to me.”

Perfuma started to apologize again and Catra looked at her with a raised eyebrow and Perfuma blushed and stayed quiet. They rode the next few minutes in silence and then Catra saw grazing sheep and then a big iron gate. Then she saw Lynda coming out of the barn and had sudden conflicting feelings of both wanting to hide and to shout out the window at her. Finally she went with greeting her.

“Lynda!” Catra shouted as she leaned out the window as the truck came to a stop. Lynda’s face broke into a huge grin as she came trotting down the drive up to the barn and met Catra at the front of the truck.

“Catra! It’s good to see you!” she said as she didn’t wait and grabbed Catra in a hug. Catra went stiff for a moment and then leaned into it and hugged her back before Lynda sat her back down. “By the way, I didn’t tell you but I go by Scorpia now.”

“Not so worried about the tattoo anymore, huh?” Catra said.

“Nope,” Scorpia grinned. “Although Mom is a little mad about it. She’s not a tattoo person.”

“Did you tell her about the other thing,” Catra asked.

“You mean about being a lesbian?” Scorpia said and Catra laughed as Scorpia actually sang the word lesbian. “Why yes, I did. That went just fine.”

“Good, you deserve good things, buddy,” Catra said.

“Thanks,” Scorpia said shyly. Then she looked up and noticed Perfuma who was standing beside the truck. Catra saw Scorpia’s face go still and turned to see Perfuma standing there. Perfuma gave a little wave and Catra nodded.

“Scorpia, this is Perfuma,” Catra said.

“Ummm, hello,” Scorpia said as the tall woman looked down for a moment and then back up with a nervous smile.

“Hi,” Perfuma said with a shy smile, her hand tracing patterns on the hood of the truck.

Catra looked back and forth between the two as nothing else got said. Then she heard Tara shout hello from the side of the barn and started walking over to her.

“I’ll be right back, um, OK?” Catra said, while neither one of them spoke.

When Catra got over to Tara, she was leaning against the barn and said to Catra, "Well, those two are going to be busy for a minute. How are you doing?"

Catra shrugged as she said, "Working at Camp Bright Moon now. Can't complain."

"Scorp over there gave me a rundown," Tara said. "That Joshua guy came over here a week ago trying to get me to go and run his barn for him. Guess he's having trouble keeping people."

Catra grinned. Joshua ran Camp Horde for the Lord and she didn't mind hearing about him having trouble.

"Can't imagine why," Catra said. "He hardly paid us poor saps. I can't see a real horse person wanting to mess with it."

Tara clapped a hand on Catra's shoulder as she said, "Hey, don't sell yourself short. You had a well-kept barn over there. You're a real horse person. I'm going to give him another week to stew and then go offer to buy some of his horses off him. Should be able to rake him over the coals pretty good."

"Take him for all he's worth," Catra said with a laugh.

"OK, so I don't think those two are going to be any help. I know you're all puny and stuff but can you still haul hay?" Tara said.

Catra turned around to see the two in question holding hands in front of the truck and talking, neither taking their eyes off the other.

“You’ve gotta be kidding me,” Catra said with an eye roll.

“She was due for a break anyway,” Tara said with a chuckle as she clapped Catra on the shoulder. “Come on. Let those two have a moment and grab a bale.”

End Notes

Not much to say here. Thank you for reading!

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